

2c. Content of Developments in Jewish thought (H573/05)

In this component, learners have the opportunity to undertake a systematic study of key concepts within the development of Jewish thought. Learners will explore religious beliefs, values and teachings, their interconnections, how they have developed historically and how they are presently discussed.

In *Jewish Oral and Written Law* learners will examine the Babylonian Talmud and *Pirkei Avot* as sources of wisdom and authority. This topic will enable learners to consider the authority of scripture as the word of G-d and investigate the development of rabbinic law.

The idea of covenant is central to Judaism, and through studying the Abrahamic and Mosaic covenants learners will develop their understanding of the role these texts and ideas play in the Jewish conception of G-d and Jewish identity.

Learners will also explore the writings of Maimonides as a source of authority and wisdom within Judaism. This study of a key figure is designed to give learners an insight into the development of medieval Judaism and demonstrate the impact of Maimonides' thinking.

To explore Jewish ideas about *Suffering and Hope* learners will study key texts and the concept of messianic hope, in order to develop their understanding of core theological thinking within Judaism, including ideas about the nature of human life and death.

Halakhah explores practices that shape and express religious identity, and the diversity of practice within Judaism. Further, in *Conversion*, learners will study responses to conversion from biblical times through to the modern day.

The historical change and development brought about by the challenge of secularisation forms a key area of study. In studying *The Jewish Haskalah and Jewish Emancipation*, learners will look at Mendelssohn and the development of Jewish self-consciousness. Learners will investigate the idea of cultural assimilation and the birth of the reform movement.

Learners will also explore the more contemporary issues of the development of *Zionism* and *The State of Israel* and will consider the relationship between these areas and biblical ideals. Further, these topics highlight recent, key political thinking within Judaism.

Gender and Relationships will continue the study of Jewish emancipation, with a detailed investigation into feminist theology.

Post-Holocaust Theology and *Chagall: Art as Spiritual Resistance* will encourage learners to reflect on the question of the existence of G-d post-Holocaust. Issues of religious tolerance, respect, equality and discrimination will be studied in this section alongside social and historical developments in thought.

Technical Terms

While the majority of non-English terms (which are not names of texts, philosophical schools, or particular religious approaches) within the specification and assessment materials will be accompanied by a translation, there are some that are considered to be key technical terms that learners are expected to recognise and understand without a provided translation.

For this component, the following are considered technical terms and will not necessarily be accompanied by a translation:

- *Agunah*
- *Halakhah*

- *Kibbutzim*
- *Mitzvot*
- *Mikveh*
- *Niddah*
- *Parve*
- *Shehitah*
- *Shemittah*
- *Shohet*
- *Trefah*.

The spelling of words which have been transliterated from non-Roman alphabets will be used consistently through the assessment materials. Learners will not be penalised for the use of other common spellings.

1. Foundations

The origins and development of Judaism, and the sources of wisdom on which it is based

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Jewish Oral and Written Law*	• Introduction to Jewish oral and written sources • The Babylonian Talmud • <i>Pirkei Avot</i> chapter 1	• Torah/Tanakh • Talmud (<i>mishnah</i> and <i>gemara</i>) • order of transmission of the oral tradition • origins and transmission of the Babylonian Talmud • the development of <i>halakhah</i>, including <i>Shulkhan Arukh</i>; the importance of the oral and written Torah for Jewish belief and life today • order and authority of oral transmission • law and ethical principles within the text • the nature and interpretation of Torah as shown through <i>Pirkei Avot</i> chapter 1
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Jewish oral and written law, including: • the authority of written texts as the word of G-d and challenges to this claim • the oral Torah as divine revelation and challenges to this claim • diversity of approach in Orthodox and Progressive communities to oral and written law		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> • Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003) <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapters 21–24 • Barton, J. and Bowden, J. (2004) <i>The Original Story. God, Israel and the World</i>, Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd, Chapter 5 • Hoffman, C.M. (2010) <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, Chapter 3		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Covenant in the Torah*	- The Abrahamic Covenant (Genesis 12:1–3, 7; 15:1–21; 17:1–21) - The Mosaic Covenant (Exodus 19:1–20:20)	- the theme of land - the theme of the Jews as a chosen people - the form of covenants, for example comparison to Ancient Near Eastern parity and suzerainty treaties, speakers, requirements, witnesses, curses and blessings - the sign of covenants, for example circumcision, ‘cutting of the covenant’ - exegesis; contemporary views as to the date, authorship and theological purpose of the text - the theme of land - the theme of the Jews as a chosen people - the theme of the law - the form of covenants, for example comparison to Ancient Near Eastern parity and suzerainty treaties, speakers, requirements, witnesses, curses and blessings - the sign of covenants, for example sprinkling of blood, Law - exegesis; contemporary views as to the date, authorship and theological purpose of the text
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to covenant in the Torah, including: - how the idea of covenant: - is a particularly Jewish concept that has developed over the studied texts - shows a developing relationship between G-d and the Jews - how key themes within covenant are central to Jewish thought - how contemporary scholarship views and understands the narrative text		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003) <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapters 66–67 - Anderson, B. (1998: 4th Edition) <i>The Living world of the Old Testament</i>, Longman, Chapter 3 - Davies, P.R. (2015: 2nd Edition) <i>In Search of ‘Ancient Israel’: A Study in Biblical Origins</i>, Bloomsbury, T&T Clark, Chapters 2, 4 and 7		

2. Insight

Beliefs, teachings and ideas about human life, the world and ultimate reality

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Maimonides: Jewish Theologian and Philosopher*	- Maimonides' 13 Principles of Faith (<i>Commentary on the Mishnah</i>, Sanhedrin 10): - Principles 1–5 (Conception of G-d) - Principles 6–9 (Revelation) - Principles 10–13 (G-d's relationship with man)	- existence of G-d, G-d's unity, incorporeality, eternity and the worship alone of G-d - prophecy, Moses, Torah, immutability of Torah - G-d's knowledge of man, reward and punishment, messiah and resurrection of the dead - for each of the 13 Principles of Faith learners should study: - how these are rooted in the history of Biblical Judaism - how they are developed in the thinking of Maimonides - how they are developed by living Judaism
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Maimonides as a theologian and philosopher, including: - how the beliefs, teachings and ideas about the nature and existence of God are shown within the teachings of Maimonides - how beliefs, teachings and ideas about the self, death and afterlife are shown within the teachings of Maimonides - how the 13 Principles were viewed by the contemporaries of Maimonides - how the 13 Principles are viewed today by Orthodox and Progressive communities		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003) <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapters 32–33 and 89 - Selections from Twersky, I. (ed.), (1976) <i>Maimonides Reader</i>, Behrman House Publishing - Weiss, R. (1991) <i>Maimonides' Ethics: The Encounter of Philosophical and Religious Morality</i>, University of Chicago Press, Part I		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Suffering and hope*	- Suffering (a study of Job 1–4, 38 and 42) - Messianic Hope	- apparent hiddenness of G-d, nature of evil and suffering and concepts of morality presented within the book - suffering as punishment - undeserved suffering - individual suffering: propensity of wickedness and suffering of the righteous - the nature and role of messiah and messianic hope - the messiah in the Hebrew Bible (for example Micah 4) - messiah in the teachings of Maimonides - present-day Jewish positions on the messiah
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to suffering and hope, including: - how faith and trust in G-d is required to deal with the presence of suffering in the world - the messianic hope and how this answers, or not, the question of suffering - the contrast between the way in which Messianic hope is understood and interpreted by Orthodox and Progressive Jewish groups today	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Barton, J. and Bowden, J. (2004) <i>The Original Story. God, Israel and the World</i>, Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd, Chapter 2 - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (1997) <i>The Jewish Messiah</i>, T and T Clark - Soggin, A. (1999) <i>An Introduction to the History of Israel and Judah</i>, SCM, Chapters 1 and 10	

3. Living

The diversity of ethics and practice, including those that shape and express religious identity, the role of the community of believers and key moral principles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
<i>Halakhah*</i>	<i>Halakhah</i> in relation to food, including: <i>kashrut</i> (general) - meat, dairy, <i>parve</i> <i>shehitah</i> <i>Halakhah</i> in relation to business ethics, including: - loans - deception <i>Halakhah</i> in relation to sex, including: - sex as <i>mitzvot</i> <i>niddah</i> ‘prohibited’ sexual acts or relations	- scriptural origins and rationales for observance, for example holiness and self-discipline - origins and development of practice, the ‘kosher kitchen’ - origins and development of practice, <i>shohet</i> and prohibition of <i>trefah</i> - origins and development of thought, charging of interest and usury - verbal deception, monetary deception, accuracy in weights/measures, contemporary applications - sex within marriage, sex for procreation, sex as an act of pleasure - origins and observance of practice including use of <i>mikveh</i> - acts and relations that could be considered controversial or prohibited, including same-sex relationships
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to <i>halakhah</i>, including: - how <i>halakhah</i> has shaped the expression of Jewish religious identity - the diversity of ethics and practice in the living community through a study of orthodox and progressive approaches to halakhah in relation to food, business ethics and sex - the relevance of <i>halakhah</i> for the twenty-first century		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003) <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapter 52, Chapters 63–64 and 84–87 - Hoffman, C.M. (2010), <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, Chapters 6 and 9		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Conversion*	- The process of conversion to Judaism as outlined within the <i>Shulkhan Arukh</i> - Responses within modern Judaism to conversion	- circumcision - questions to proselyte <i>mikveh</i> - the differences and similarities between the male and female conversion processes - patrilineal descent and 'Jewishness' - conversion and <i>halakhah</i> - orthodox and progressive approaches to conversion
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to conversion, including: - how Judaism can be seen as a non-missionising religion - the diversity of practice in the living community through a study of orthodox and progressive approaches to conversion - how conversion for a proselyte will shape and express religious identity - the role of the community of believers in the conversion process	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Epstein, L. (1994) <i>Conversion to Judaism: A Guidebook</i>, Jason Aronson, Chapters 4, 5 and 7 - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003) <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapter 90 - Hoffman, C.M. (2010) <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, Chapter 17	

4. Development

Significant social and historical developments in Jewish thought, such as those influenced by ethics, philosophy or studies of religion

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
The Jewish Haskalah and Jewish Emancipation	- the European enlightenment and the Jewish Haskalah, including: - the origins of Haskalah: Moses Mendelssohn - the development of Haskalah - emancipation (Jews as citizens)	- existence of G-d, truth and reason, defence of the Jewish religion, revealed Law, modernisation of Jewish life (i.e. translation, the Biur) - Maskilim - the creation of secular Jewish culture, emphasis on Jewish history and Jewish identity rather than religion - the civil liberties and development of European Jewish-Christian relations that came with emancipation - the impact of emancipation on Jewish communities - the development of Jewish self-consciousness - the development of Reform and Progressive Judaism
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the Jewish Haskalah and Jewish emancipation, including: - the extent to which Mendelssohn and the Haskalah transformed Jewish life and thought - the challenge posed by the development of science and rational thought for the existence of G-d and the Jewish way of life - Jewish Haskalah in the context of European Christian enlightenment - the development of pluralism and diversity within Judaism	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Vital, D. (2001) <i>A People Apart: A Political History of the Jews in Europe 1789–1939</i> (Oxford History of Modern Europe), Oxford University Press, Chapters 1.I, 2.I–V and 3.I–IV - Sorkin, D. (2004) <i>Moses Mendelssohn and the Religious Enlightenment</i>, Halban Publishers, Part One - Kessler, E. (2010) <i>An Introduction to Jewish-Christian Relations (Introduction to Religion)</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 6	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Zionism	- Political Zionism (Theodor Herzl) - Cultural Zionism (Asher Ginzberg/Ahad Ha'am) - Modern Zionism	- key moments in the life and work of Herzl: World Zionist organisation, philosophy for a homeland, diplomatic negotiations, visit to the 'Holy land', Uganda programme - key moments in the life and work of Ginzberg: visits to the 'Holy Land', the call for the establishment of a permanent and authoritative centre for Jewish value, spirit and ethics, reviving Hebrew and Jewish culture - development of different Zionist movements and schools of thought; Revisionist, Labour, Liberal - Orthodox and Progressive Jewish responses to Zionism - Jewish opposition to Zionism, for example <i>Haredi</i>, <i>Neturei Karta</i> - non-Jewish support for, and opposition to, Zionism
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Zionism, including: - how the continuing conflicts within, and towards, the Zionist movements have impacted upon Jewish identity and societal relations - if Zionism has done more damage than good - if Zionism is a 'solution' to anti-Semitism, and whether or not anti-Zionism is merely anti-Semitism		
Contextual references <i>For reference, the ideas of Herzl listed above can be found in:</i> - Herzl, T. (1896) <i>The Jewish State</i> Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003), <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapters 47–48 - Kessler, E. (2010) <i>An Introduction to Jewish-Christian Relations (Introduction to Religion)</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 8 - C.M. Hoffman (2010), <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, chapter 17		

5. Society

The relationship between religion and society, including issues such as how religions adapt on encountering different cultures; religious tolerance, respect and recognition and views of other religions and non-religious worldviews; religion, equality and discrimination; the political and social influence of religious institutions

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
State of Israel and the Biblical Promised Land	- the significance of the concept of the Land of Israel for Judaism - the State of Israel - differences between the Promised Land and the State of Israel	- the historical and covenantal context as the 'Promised Land' - the historical exile of Israel to Babylon in the sixth century BCE and the return to the Promised Land - the dispersion of the Jewish people between 70 CE and 1948 - Zionism and the 'Land' - concepts related to the Land; stewardship, <i>shemittah</i>, the Year of Jubilees, the establishment of <i>kibbutzim</i> - details of the creation and development of modern Israel, including the significance of: 1945–1948: Jewish-British conflict in Palestine, UN plan for partition 1948: Declaration of the State of Israel – Ben-Gurion, Scroll of Independence, the following migration of Jews into the State, Zionism - conflict – Six Day War, Yom Kippur War, Palestinian intifada, recent conflict and political tensions - religious and political responses to the present day State of Israel e.g <i>Neturei Karta</i> and <i>Gush Emunim</i>, <i>Orthodox and Progressive views</i> - differences in the boundaries of the land
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the State of Israel and the Biblical Promised Land, including: - the Land as a central tenant of Jewish thought from Biblical times onwards - tensions surrounding the establishment of a Jewish homeland - different viewpoints within Judaism, and within wider society, towards the importance and significance of the Land - the claims of Israelis' and Palestinians' regarding both the Land and the creation of a Jewish State		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Barton J., and Bowden J. (2004), <i>The Original Story. God, Israel and the World</i>, Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd, Chapter 5 - Gilbert, M. (1999) <i>Israel: A History</i>, Black Swan, Chapters 7–15 - Hoffman, C.M. (2010) <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, Chapter 17		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Rethinking Women: Jewish Feminism	- an introduction to Jewish Feminism - rethinking women within Torah - rethinking women in marriage	- the rationale behind the development of Jewish feminism and Jewish feminist theology - Orthodox and Progressive responses to feminism and women in leading roles in Judaism - to be studied with reference to Judith Plaskow, including: - reshaping Jewish memory (Torah) to reclaim the Torah for women - the discussion surrounding Sinai and the covenant - to be studied with reference to Rachel Adler, including: - the nature of traditional Jewish marriage; <i>agunah</i>, notion of acquisition - Adler's Lovers Covenant or <i>Brit Ahuvim</i>; rethinking marriage as partnership, dissolving the <i>Brit Ahuvim</i>, the reconstruction and reconfiguration of the marriage tradition
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the changing roles and ideas about women, including: - the responses, and tensions, within Judaism to changing views of gender - the responses, and tensions, within Judaism to Jewish and secular forms of feminism - the impact of Jewish feminism on Jewish and secular society - orthodox and Progressive responses to 'rethinking' women in Torah - orthodox and Progressive responses to 'rethinking' women in marriage		
Contextual references <i>For reference, the ideas of Plaskow and Adler listed above can be found in:</i> - Plaskow, J. <i>Standing Again at Sinai. Judaism from a Feminist Perspective</i>, Chapter 2 - Adler, R. <i>Engendering Judaism. An Inclusive Theology and Ethics</i>, Chapter 5 Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Jewish Women's Archive (www.jwa.org) - Hoffman, C.M. (2010) <i>Teach Yourself: Judaism</i>, Hodder Education, Chapters 5 and 9 - Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003), <i>Judaism. History, Belief and Practice</i>, Routledge, Chapters 53 and 84		

6. Challenges

Challenges facing religious thought from areas such as science, secularisation, migration and multi-cultural societies and changing gender roles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Post-Holocaust theology	- the responses of theologians and thinkers to the Holocaust, including: - the Refutation or 'Death' of G-d (Richard Rubenstein) - the 614th Commandment (Emile Fackenheim) - Churban (Ignaz Maybaum) - Hidden G-d (<i>Hester Panim</i>) (Eliezer Berkovitz)	- G-d and the death camps - doubt of G-d - G-d as the Ultimate Nothing/Nothingness and G-d - religious duty - Jews forbidden to hand Hitler a posthumous victory - role of Hitler - Holocaust and Sacrifice - G-d's providential plan - remnant - free will - Hidden G-d (<i>Hester Panim</i>) - Holocaust as a human and historical event 'Job' and the modern Jew
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to challenge that the Holocaust has posed to Judaism, including: - a comparison of the ways in which the listed scholars addressed the issues raised by the Holocaust - the challenges posed by the Holocaust for the traditional view of the G-d of classical theism - the philosophical and ethical consequences of the Holocaust for understanding the role of G-d and man in the world - the physical consequences on world Jewry of the Holocaust and the increase of anti-Semitism post-Holocaust - Orthodox and Progressive responses to the Holocaust	
	Contextual references <i>For reference, the ideas of Rubenstein, Fackenheim, Maybaum and Berkovitz listed above can be found in:</i> - Rubenstein, R. <i>After Auschwitz: History, Theology, and Contemporary Judaism</i> - Fackenheim, E. <i>The Jewish return into history</i> - Maybaum, I. <i>The Face of God after Auschwitz</i> - Berkovitz, E. <i>Faith after the Holocaust</i>	

Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority
*Learners will be given credit for referring to any **appropriate** scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful*

- Cohn-Sherbok, D. (1992) *Holocaust Theology: A Reader*, NYU Press, Parts I and III
- Cohn-Sherbok, D. (2003), *Judaism. History, Belief and Practice*, Routledge, Chapters 49–50
- Hoffman, C.M. (2010), *Teach Yourself: Judaism*, Hodder Education, Chapter 16

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Chagall: art as resistance	• life of Chagall • the art of Chagall as a depiction of Jewish life, Jewish persecution and Jewish resistance, as depicted in: ○ The Fiddler (1913) ○ The Praying Jew (The Rabbi of Vitebsk) (1914) ○ Solitude (1933) ○ White Crucifixion (1938)	• the Nazi campaign against ‘art’ ○ classification of degenerate ‘art’ and fate of those classed as degenerate artists ○ Chagall as a degenerate artist ○ the Entartete Kunst exhibit (1937) ○ the escape of Chagall from the Nazi regime • symbol and metaphor alluding to the Jewish world of those living within the Pale of Settlement, including: ○ Jewish–Christian relations ○ Shtetl life ○ Hasidic Judaism ○ role of music • the ritual of prayer within Judaism and how this is shown through the use of the Tallit and Tefillin • symbol and metaphor alluding to destruction and sacrifice in Jewish history, including: ○ sacrifice (white heifer) ○ Shtetl life (violin) ○ eternal hope (angel) ○ destruction (smoke) • symbol and metaphor alluding to Jewish persecution, including: ○ Jewish identity of Jesus (for example loincloth as <i>tallit</i>)

	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the art of Chagall as a response to the Nazi regime and Holocaust, including: • the role of art as a form of Jewish resistance during the Nazi regime and in the post-war period • the art of Chagall as an act of resistance to: ○ Jewish life in the Pale of Settlement ○ destruction and persecution of Jews under the Nazi regime ○ classification as a degenerate artist
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> • Commentaries on the prescribed works from Polonsky, G. (2001) <i>Chagall</i>, Phaidon Press • Wilson, J. (2009) <i>Marc Chagall (Jewish Encounters Series)</i>, Schocken • Peters, O. (2014) <i>Degenerate Art: The Attack on Modern Art in Nazi Germany 1937</i> Prestel Publishing, Pages 16–35 and 106–135